

UNIT 3: VIETNAM COAST GUARD

I. INTRODUCTION

The Vietnam Coast Guard **shall be a** people's armed force and a specialised force of the State. The lesson gives an overview of general issues about the history of formation, position and functions; principles of organization and operation; mission; authority; scope of operation; organizational system; equipment.

II. TEXT

*** Overview of formation history, location, function**



The establishment of the Vietnam Coast Guard

Vietnam Coast Guard was established on August 28, 1998, under Decision No. 1069/1998/QĐ-BQP of the Minister of National Defense on the establishment of the Vietnam Marine Police (*the predecessor of the Vietnam Coast Guard Command*). The Vietnam Coast Guard **shall be a** people's armed force and a specialised force of the State, playing core roles in enforcing laws, and protecting national security, order and safety at sea. The Vietnam Coast Guard shall perform the function of counseling the Minister of National Defence to promulgate, according to his/her competence, or to make recommendations to the Party and the State on the policies and laws on the protection of national security, order and safety at sea; protecting state sovereignty, sovereignty rights and jurisdiction in the territorial waters of Vietnam; managing security, order and safety, as well as ensuring the observance of Vietnamese laws, international treaties and conventions to which the Socialist Republic of Vietnam is a contracting party, or international

agreements within its competence (*in Article 3 of the Law on Vietnam Coast Guard 2018*).

- **Principles of organization and operation of the Vietnam Coast Guard**

Being put under the absolute and direct leadership in all aspects of the Communist Party of Vietnam, the overall command of the State President, the unified State management of the Government, and the direct command and administration of the Minister of National Defence. Abiding by the Constitution and laws of Vietnam, as well as international treaties and conventions to which the Socialist Republic of Vietnam is a contracting party. Being organised in a centralised, unified and hierarchical manner from the Vietnam Coast Guard's Command to grassroots level units. Acting on its own initiative in preventing, detecting combating, handling and penalising the law violations. Combining the missions of protecting state sovereign, sovereign rights and jurisdiction, and managing security, order and safety at sea with those of marine economic

development. Relying upon the people, promote the people's strength and be put under their supervision (***in Article 4 of the Law on Vietnam Coast Guard 2018***).

A Vietnam Coast Guard squadron on patrol

- **Missions of the Vietnam Coast Guard**

Collecting information, analyzing, evaluating and forecasting the situation so as to recommend advocacy, solutions and plans for national security protection and law enforcement at sea; studying, analysing, forecasting and counseling the authorities to promulgate policies and legislation on the protection of national sovereignty, sovereign rights, jurisdiction and national security in the territorial waters of Vietnam; securing order and safety; preventing and combating crimes and law violations at sea (***in Article 8 of the Law on Vietnam Coast Guard 2018***).



Vietnam Coast Guard conducting combat readiness training

- **Authority of the Vietnam Coast Guard**



Making a record of violating ships

Patrolling, inspecting and controlling people, vessels, cargo and luggage in the territorial waters of Vietnam under the provisions of this law and other relevant law provisions.

Using weapons, explosives and supporting tools. Using professional technical means and equipment. Imposing legal penalties for administrative violations based on law provisions for administrative violation penalties.

Conducting a number of criminal investigation activities in accordance with the law on the organisation of criminal investigation agencies and criminal procedure law.

Chasing vessels with law violations at sea.

Mobilising people, vessels and civil technical means and equipment of Vietnamese offices, organisations and citizens in case of emergency.

Requesting foreign organisations and individuals operating in the territorial waters of Vietnam to provide support and assistance in case of emergencies.

Arresting seagoing vessels as regulated by law. Applying working measures prescribed by this Law (***in Article 9 of the Law on Vietnam Coast Guard 2018***).

- **Scope of operation performed by the Vietnam Coast Guard.**

The Vietnam Coast Guard shall operate in the territorial waters of Vietnam to perform its functions, missions and authority as regulated this Law. In the case of serving for humanitarian or peaceful purposes, combating, preventing and controlling crimes and law violations, the Vietnam Coast Guard may operate outside the territorial waters of Vietnam; while on duty, it shall be required to comply with the laws of Vietnam, international treaties and conventions to which the Socialist Republic of Vietnam is a contracting party, and international agreements related to the functions, missions and authority of the Vietnam Coast Guard (***in Article 11 of the Law on Vietnam Coast Guard 2018***).

* Organizational system of the Vietnam Coast Guard

1. The organizational system of the Vietnam Coast Guard includes: the Vietnam Coast Guard High Command; Coast Guard Regional Command and units directly under the Vietnam Coast Guard High Command (the 1st Coast Guard Regional Command, the 2nd Coast Guard Regional Command, the 3rd Coast Guard Regional Command, the 4th Coast Guard Regional Command; No. 1 Narcotics Prevention Base; No. 2 Narcotics Prevention Base; No. 3 Narcotics Prevention Base; No. 4 Narcotics Prevention Base, No. 1 Reconnaissance Base, No. 2 Reconnaissance Base; Vietnam Coast Guard training and education center and Grassroots level units). (***Article 7 of Decree No. 61/2019/ND-CP dated July 10, 2019, of the Government detailing some articles and measures to implement the Vietnam Coast Guard Law***).

2. Operational scope and management area:



- + The 1st Regional Coast Guard Command manages the waters from Bac Luan estuary in Quang Ninh province to Con Co island in Quang Tri province;
- + The 2nd Regional Coast Guard Command manages the waters from Con Co island in Quang Tri province to Cu Lao Xanh in Binh Dinh province;
- + The 3rd Regional Coast Guard Regional manages the waters from Cu Lao Xanh, Binh Dinh province to the north shore of Dinh An estuary, Tra Vinh province;
- + The 4th Regional Coast Guard Regional manages the waters from the north shore of Dinh An estuary in Tra Vinh province to Ha Tien in Kien Giang province.

The Operational scope and management area of No. 1 Narcotics Prevention Base; No. 2 Narcotics Prevention Base; No. 3 Narcotics Prevention Base; No. 4 Narcotics Prevention Base, No. 1 Reconnaissance Base, No. 2 Reconnaissance Base is regulated by the Vietnam Coast Guard Commandant.

* Equipment of the Vietnam Coast Guard



The Vietnam Coast Guard ship 8002 and Coast Guard ship 8003 jointly patrol the sea

The Vietnam Coast Guard shall be equipped with vessels, boats, aircraft and other means; weapons, explosives, supporting tools, and other technical and professional equipment for implementing the assigned functions, missions and authority (*in Article 33 of the Law on Vietnam Coast Guard 2018*).

With a spirit of being positive, proactive, not afraid of danger, and ready to overcome big waves and storms, ships of the Vietnam Coast Guard have successfully carried out hundreds of rescues and saved the property of fishermen in distress in far - away sea. The Vietnam Coast Guard always identifies and accompanies fishermen, search and rescue at sea as a combat duty in peacetime, a "heart command", contributing to building the image of officers and soldiers: persistent, close to fishermen, and propagating the law. The presence of the Vietnam Coast Guard at sea, especially on distant seas, has become a belief, a solid fulcrum for fishermen to firmly reach out to sea, contributing to the course of building the entire people's national defense posture, and the people's security posture at sea.

III. GRAMMAR

***Gerund**

A gerund is a verb in its “ing” (present participle) form that functions as a noun that names an activity rather than a person or thing. Any action verb can be made into a gerund.

Eg: The missions of the Vietnam Coast Guard are collecting information, analyzing, evaluating and forecasting the situation to propose guidelines, solutions and plans for national security protection and law enforcement at sea

One of the powers of the Vietnam Coast Guard is mobilizing people, ships and civil technical means and equipment of Vietnamese agencies, organizations and citizens in case of emergency.

- Gerunds can appear at the beginning of a sentence when used as a subject:

Eg: Preserving sovereignty, sovereign rights and jurisdiction of the country in the waters of Vietnam is a duty of our unit.

- Gerunds can act as an object following the verb:

Eg: Daniel quit smoking a year ago.

- Gerunds can serve as an object after a preposition:

Eg: This unit specializes in analyzing military intelligence data.

- Some verbs and verb phrases are directly followed by a gerund:

Eg: The authority avoids using nuclear weapons in wars.

- Some verbs can be followed by a gerund or an infinitive without causing a change in meaning:

Eg: Some people prefer getting up early in the morning.

Some people prefer to get up early in the morning

- Some verbs can be followed by a gerund or infinitive but with a change in meaning:

Eg: He remembered meeting the pilot at the entrance buoy. (He remembered the act of meeting the pilot at the entrance buoy)

He remembered to meet the pilot at the entrance buoy. (He remembered the pilot at the entrance buoy and meet him)

IV. VOCABULARY

1	administrative	/əd'mɪnɪstrətɪv/	a	hành chính
2	advise	/əd'vaɪz/	v	tham mưu
3	arrest	/ə'rest/	v	bắt giữ
4	civil	/'sɪvl/	a	dân sự
5	Coast Guard Regional Command	/kəʊst ɡɑ:d 'ri:dʒənəl kə'mɑ:nd/	n	BTL Vùng Cảnh sát biển
6	Communist Party of Vietnam	/'kɒmjənɪst 'pɑ:ti əv /	n	Đảng Cộng sản Việt Nam
7	competence	/'kɒmpɪtəns/	n	thẩm quyền
8	Constitution	/,kɒnstɪ'tju:ʃn/	n	hiến pháp
9	core	/kɔ:(r)/	n	nòng cốt
10	criminal procedure	/'krɪmɪnl prə'si:dʒə(r)/	n	tổ tụng hình sự
11	decentralization	/,di:ˌsentərəlaɪ'zeɪʃ n/	n	phân cấp
12	Decree	/dɪ'kri:/	n	nghị định
13	detect	/dɪ'tekt/	n	phát hiện
14	domination	/,dɒmɪ'neɪʃn/	n	sự thống lĩnh

15	estuary	/ˈestʃuəri/	n	cửa sông
16	explosives	/ɪkˈspləʊsɪv/	n	vật liệu nổ
17	formation	/fɔːˈmeɪʃn/	n	hình thành
18	grassroot	/ˌɡrɑːsˈruːts/	n	cấp cơ sở
19	guidelines	/ˈɡaɪdlaɪn/	n	chủ trương
20	humanitarian	/hjuːˌmænɪˈteəriən/	n	nhân đạo
21	incident	/ˈɪnsɪdənt/	n	sự cố
22	inspection	/ɪnˈspekʃn/	n	kiểm tra
23	interest	/ˈɪntrəst/	n	lợi ích
24	jurisdiction	/ˌdʒʊərɪsˈdɪkʃn/	n	quyền tài phán
25	law enforcement	/lɔː ɪnˈfɔːsmənt/	n	thực thi pháp luật
26	legislation	/ˌledʒɪsˈleɪʃn/	n	nhiệm vụ
27	legitimate	/lɪˈdʒɪtɪmət/	n	hợp pháp
28	location	/ləʊˈkeɪʃn/	n	vị trí
29	marine economic	/məˈriːn /ˌiːkəˈnɒmɪk/	n	kinh tế biển

30	mission	/ˈmɪʃn/	n	nhiệm vụ
31	Narcotics Prevention Base	/nɑːˈkɒtɪk priˈvenʃn beɪs/	n	Đoàn đặc nhiệm pctp ma túy
32	Patrol	/pəˈtrəʊl/	n	tuần tra
33	posture	/ˈpɒstʃə(r)/	n	thế trận
34	predecessor	/ˈpriːdəsəsə(r)/	n	tiền thân
35	principle	/ˈprɪnsəpl/	n	nguyên tắc
36	promulgate	/ˈprɒmlgeɪt/	v	ban hành
37	property	/ˈprɒpəti/	n	tài sản
38	Reconnaissance Base	/rɪˈkɒnɪsns beɪs/	n	đoàn trinh sát
39	remediation	/rɪˌmiːdiˈeɪʃn/	n	khắc phục
40	sovereignty	/ˈsɒvrənti/	n	chủ quyền
41	specialised	/ˈspeʃləɪz/	a	chuyên trách
42	supervision	/ˌsuːpəˈvɪʒn/	n	giám sát
43	the waters	/ðə ˈwɔːtə(r)/	n	vùng biển
44	treaty	/ˈtriːti/	n	điều ước

45	unification	/ˌjuːnɪfɪˈkeɪʃn/	n	sự thống nhất
46	Vietnam Coast Guard High Command	/kəʊst ɡɑːd kəˈmɑːnd/	n	BTL Cảnh sát biển Việt Nam
47	violation	/ˌvaɪəˈleɪʃn/	n	Vi phạm

V. PRACTICE

Exercise 1. Read the text and answer these following questions

1. What does the VCG stand for?

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2. When was the VCG founded?

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3. What is the previous name of the VCG High Command?

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4. Is the VCG a people's armed and specialised force of the Vietnam People's Army?

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5. Which assigned functions does the VCG perform?

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6. How are the VCG High Command and its bureaus organized?

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7. Which legal document regulate organization and operation principles?

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8. How does the Communist Party of Vietnam direct the VCG?

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Exercise 2. Choose the best answer:

1. The VCG has the mission to participate in.....(build) defense and security postures and handling defense and security situations at sea.

A. to build B. built C. building D. build

2. (Access)..... pursues violations of law boats at sea is one of the powers of the VCG.

A. Accessed B. Being access C. To accessed D. Accessing

3. The VCG has the function of(advise) the Minister of National Defense to promulgate according to its competence or propose to the Party and State on policies and laws

A. to advise B. advising C. be advise D. advised

4. The presence of the VCG at sea is..... (contribute) to the course of(build) the entire people's national defense posture, and the people's security posture at sea.

A. to contribute/ building B. contributed/built
C. contributing/building D. contributed/to built

5. Searching and rescuing at sea is(combat) duty of Vietnam coast guard soldiers in peacetime

A. combating B. to combat C. be combat D. combat

Exercise 3. Work in pair. Ask and answer these question.

1. How many the Coast Guard region are there? Where are they?
2. Which the Coast Guard region that you want to work in the future? Why?